



Class 9 2022-23

THE STORY OF **VILLAGE** PALAMPUR

Ch 1 | Class 9 S.St. (Economics)

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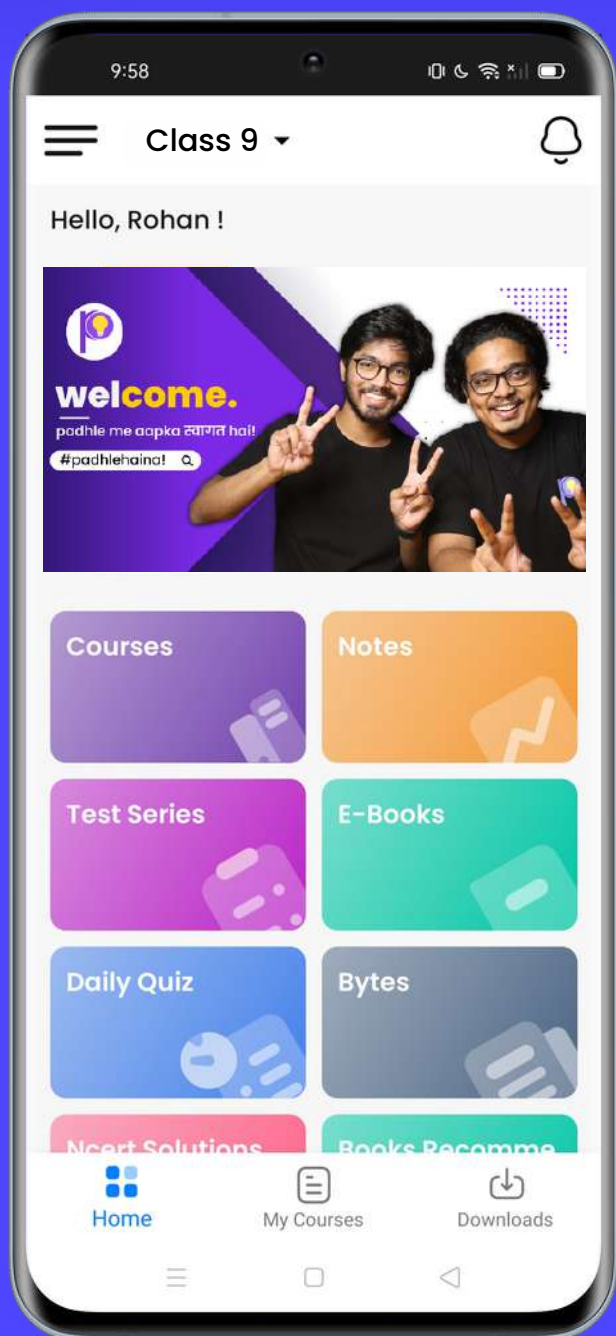
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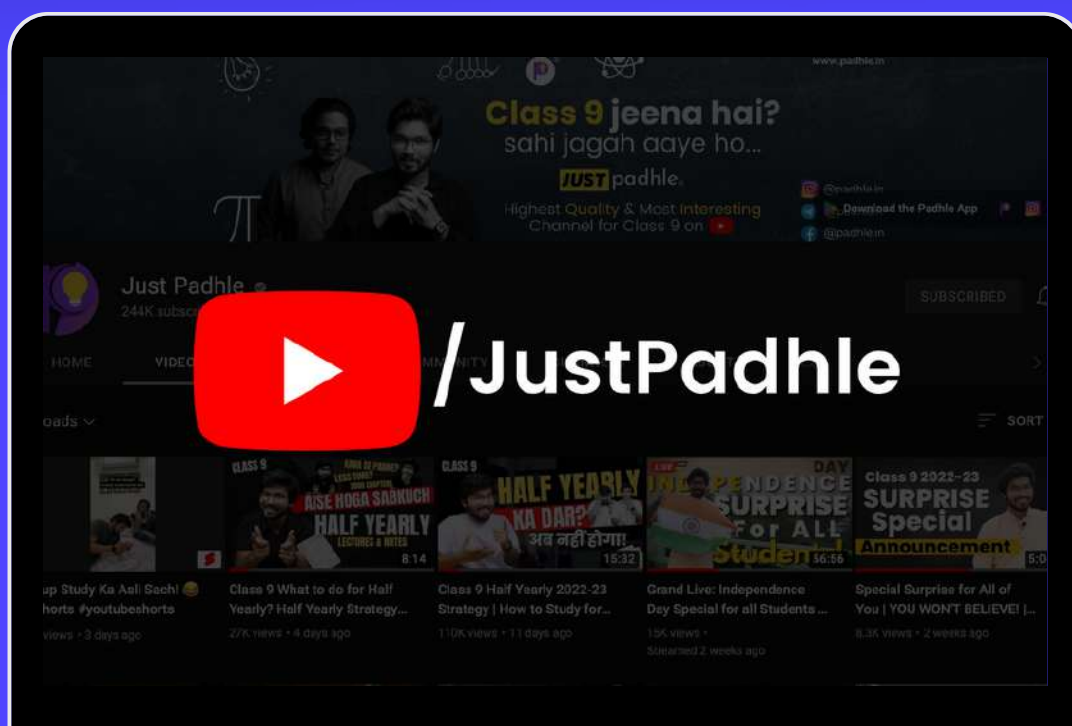
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THE STORY OF VILLAGE PALAMPUR

Overview

- The purpose of the story is to introduce some basic concepts relating to production and this we do through a story of a hypothetical village calling Palampur.
- Farming is the main activity in Palampur, whereas several other activities such as small scale manufacturing dairy, transport, etc. are carried out on a limited scale.
- These production activities need various types of resources, manmade items, human effort, money, etc.

As we read through the story of Palampur, we will learn how various resources combine to produce the desired goods and services in the village.

Introduction

- Palampur is well-connected with neighbouring villages and towns.
 - Raiganj, a big village, is 3 kms from Palampur.
- An all weather road connects the village to Raiganj and further on to the nearest small town of Shahpur.
- Many kinds of transport are visible on this road starting from bullock carts, tongas, bogeys (wooden cart drawn by buffalos) loaded with jaggery (gur) and other commodities to motor vehicles like motorcycles, jeeps, tractors and trucks.
- This village has about 450 families belonging to several different castes.
- The 80 upper caste families own the majority of land in the village.
- Their houses, some of them quite large, are made of brick with cement plastering.
- The SCs (dalits) comprise $\frac{1}{3}$ of the population and live in one corner of the village and in much smaller houses some of which

are of mud and straw.

- Most of the houses have electric connections.
- Electricity powers all the tubewells in the fields and is used in various types of small business.
- Palampur has two primary schools and one high school.
- There is a primary health centre run by the government and one private dispensary where the sick are treated.

The description above shows that Palampur has fairly well-developed system of roads, transport, electricity, irrigation, schools and health centre.

Compare these facilities with those in your nearby village.

- ▶ The story of Palampur, an imaginary village, will take us through the different types of production activities in the village.
- ▶ In villages across India, farming is the main production activity.
- ▶ The other production activities, referred to as nonfarm activities include small manufacturing, transport, shop-keeping etc.
- ▶ We shall take a look at both these types of activities, after learning a few general things about production.

Organisation of Productions

- The aim of production is to produce the goods and services that we want.
- There are four requirements for production of goods and services :
 - * Land
 - * Labour
 - * Physical Capital
 - * Human Capital

The first requirement is **land**, and other natural resources such as water, forests, minerals.

The second requirement is **labour**, i.e. people who will do the work.

- Some production activities require highly educated workers to perform the necessary tasks.
- Other activities require workers who can do manual work.
- Each worker is providing the labour necessary for production.

The third requirement is **physical capital**, i.e. the variety of inputs required at every stage during production.



► There is a fourth requirement too.

► You will need knowledge and enterprise to be able to put together land, labour and physical capital and produce an output either to use yourself or to sell in the market.

► This, these days is called human capital.

Every production is organised by combining land, labour, physical capital and human capital, which are known as factors of production.

* Farming in Palampur

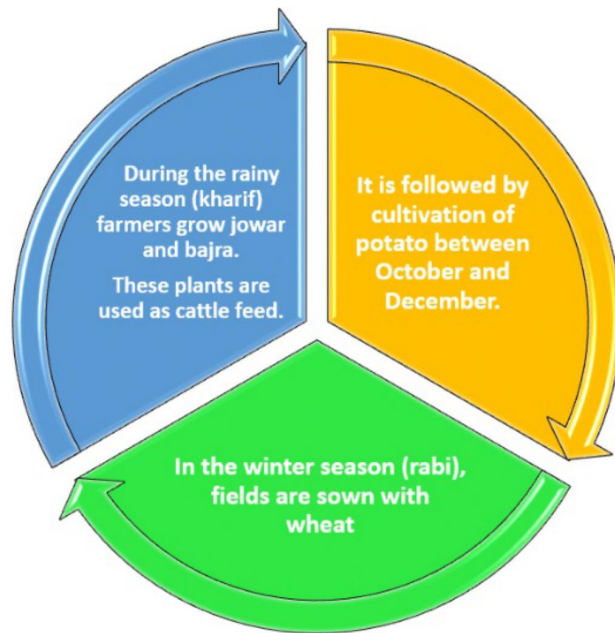
- Land is fixed
- Is there a way one can grow more from the same land?
- Will the land sustain?

1. Land is Fixed

- Farming is the main production activity in Palampur.
- 75% of the people who are working are dependent on farming for their livelihood.
- They could be farmers or farm labourers.
- The wellbeing of these people is closely related to production on the farms.
- But remember that there is a basic constraint in raising farm production.
 - Land area under cultivation is practically fixed.
- Since 1960 in Palampur, there has been no expansion in land area under cultivation.
- By then, some of the wastelands in the village had been converted to cultivable land.
- There exists no further scope to increase farm production by bringing new land under cultivation.

2. Is There a way one can grow more from the same land?

- In the cropping pattern, Palampur would resemble a village of the western part of the state of Uttar Pradesh.



- From the wheat produced, farmers keep enough wheat for the family's consumption and sell the surplus wheat at the market at Raiganj.
- A part of the land area is also devoted to sugarcane which is harvested once every year.
- Sugarcane, in its raw form, or as jaggery, is sold to traders in Shahpur.
- The main reason why farmers are able to grow three different crops in a year in Palampur is due to the well-developed system of irrigation.
- Electricity came early to Palampur.
- Its major impact was to transform the system of irrigation.
- Persian wheels were, till then, used by farmers to draw water from the wells and irrigate small fields.
- The first few tubewells were installed by the government.
- Soon, however, farmers started setting up private tubewells.
- As a result, by mid-1970s the entire cultivated area of 200 hectares (ha.) was irrigated.
- Not all villages in India have such high levels of irrigation.

- Apart from the riverine plains, coastal regions in our country are well-irrigated.
- In contrast, plateau regions such as the Deccan plateau have low levels of irrigation.
- Of the total cultivated area in the country a little less than 40% is irrigated even today.
- In the remaining areas, farming is largely dependent on rainfall.

Multiple Cropping

- ▶ To grow more than one crop on a piece of land during the year.
- ▶ It is the most common way of increasing production on a given piece of land.
- ▶ All farmers in Palampur grow atleast two main crops; many are growing potato as the third crop in the past 15 to 20 years.

Modern farming Methods

- ▶ The other way is to increase production is to use modern farming methods for higher yield.
- ▶ Yield is measured as crop produced on a given piece of land during a single season.
- ▶ Till the mid 1960s, the seeds used in cultivation were traditional ones with relatively low yields.
- ▶ Traditional seeds needed less irrigation.
 - Farmers used cow-dung and other natural manure as fertilizers.
- ▶ All these were readily available with the farmers who did not have to buy them.
- ▶ The Green Revolution in the late 1960s introduced the Indian farmer to cultivation of wheat and rice using high yielding varieties (HYVs) of seeds.
- ▶ Compared to the traditional seeds, the HYV seeds promised to produce much greater amounts of grain on a single plant.

- ▶ As a result, the same piece of land would now produce far larger quantities of foodgrains than was possible earlier.
- ▶ HYV seeds, however, needed plenty of water and also chemical fertilizers and pesticides to produce best results.
- ▶ Higher yields were possible only from a combination of HYV seeds, irrigation, chemical fertilizers, pesticides etc.

Traditional seeds	HYV seeds
These are traditional seeds which produce low yields of crops.	HYV seeds high yielding variety seeds which produce many crops with better quality.
These seeds take more time to grow into crops.	These seeds take less time to grow into crops.
These seeds less amount of water for irrigation.	These seeds more amount of water for irrigation.
These seeds are not harmful to the soil.	These seeds are harmful to soil and damage the fertility of the soil.
These seeds are economic or less expensive.	These seeds are expensive as compared to traditional seeds.
These seeds do not require pesticides and insecticides.	These seeds require an intensive amount of pesticides and insecticides.

- ▶ Farmers of Punjab, Haryana and Western Uttar Pradesh were the first to try out the modern farming method in India.
- ▶ The farmers in these regions set up tubewells for irrigation, and made use of HYV seeds, chemical fertilizers, pesticides in farming.
- ▶ Some of them bought farm machinery like tractors and threshers, which made ploughing and harvesting faster.
- ▶ They were rewarded with high yields of wheat.

In Palampur, the yield of wheat grown from the traditional varieties was 1300 kg per hectre.

With the HYV seeds, the yield went up to 3200 kg/hectre.

Farmers now had greater amounts of surplus wheat to sell in the markets.

Thus, production can be increased by

- Multiple cropping
- Using modern farming method

3. Will the land Sustain ?

• Land being a natural resource, it is necessary to be very careful in its use.

• Scientific reports indicate that the modern farming methods have overused the natural resource base

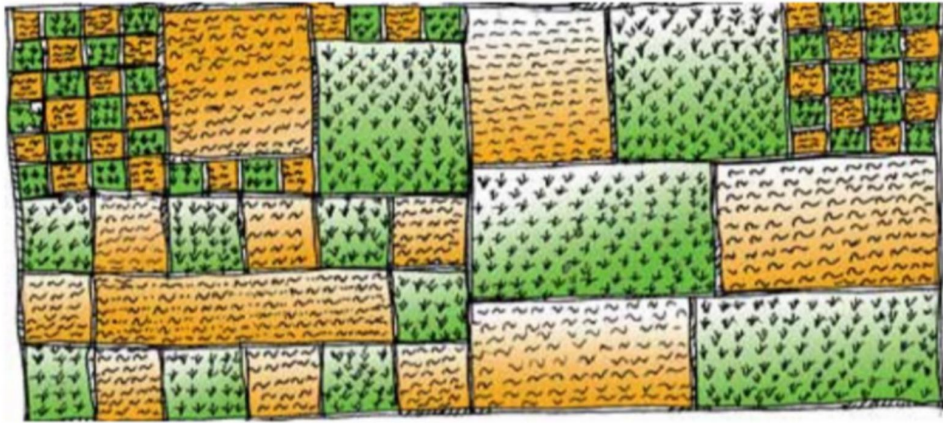
- ▶ In many areas, Green Revolution is associated with the loss of soil fertility due to increased use of chemical fertilizers.
- ▶ Also, continuous use of groundwater for tubewell irrigation has reduced the water-table below the ground.
 - Environmental resources like soil fertility and groundwater are built up over many years.
- ▶ Once destroyed it is very difficult to restore them.
- ▶ We must take care of the environment to ensure future development of agriculture.

....Chemical fertilizers provide minerals which dissolve in water and are immediately available to plants. But these may not be retained in the soil for long. They may escape from the soil and pollute groundwater, rivers and lakes. Chemical fertilizers can also kill bacteria and other micro-organisms in the soil. This means some time after their use, the soil will be less fertile than ever before....(Source: Down to Earth, New Delhi)

.....The consumption of chemical fertilizers in Punjab is highest in the country. The continuous use of chemical fertilizers has led to degradation of soil health. Punjab farmers are now forced to use more and more chemical fertilizers and other inputs to achieve the same production level. This means cost of cultivation is rising very fast....(Source: The Tribune, Chandigarh)



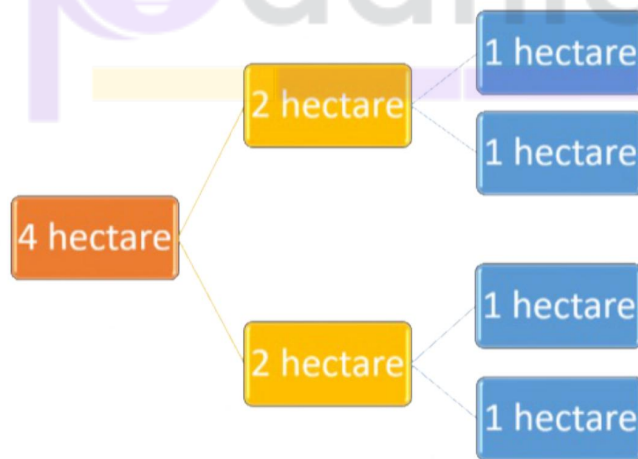
4. How is land distributed between the farmers of Palampur ?



► In Palampur, about one third of the 450 families are landless, i.e. 150 families, most of them dalits, have no land for cultivation.

- Of the remaining families who own land, 240 families cultivate small plots of land less than 2 hectre in size.

► Cultivation of such plots doesn't bring adequate income to the farmer family.



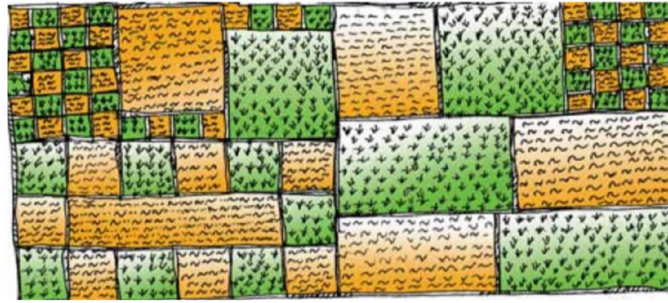
► One man has 4 hectre land and was able to feed his family and earn some extra cash from his land.

► When his 2 sons become adult, the land was divided into 2.

- Now they were hardly able to feed their families.

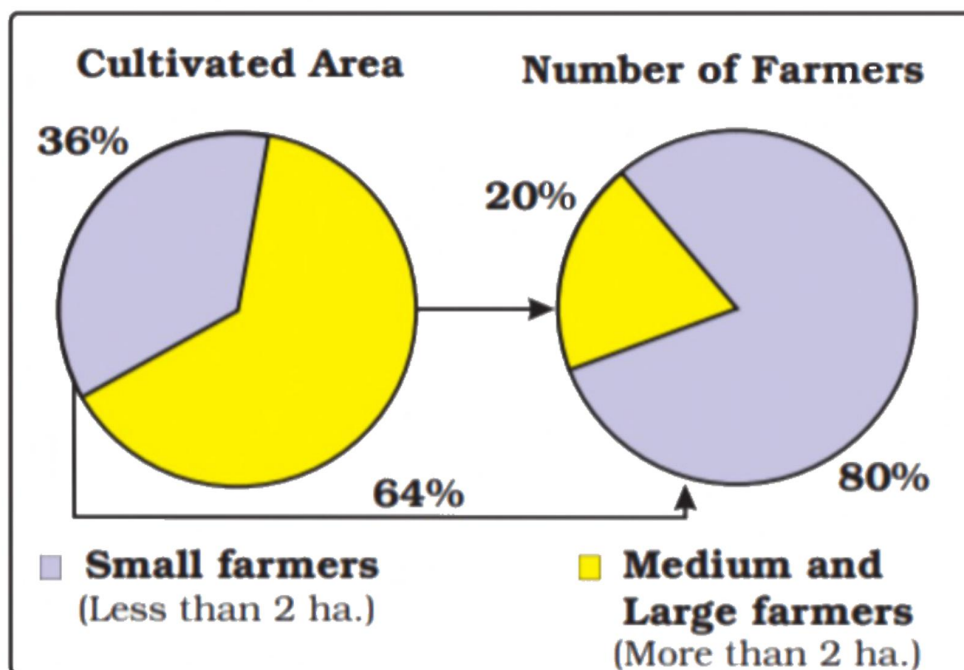
► Now when these sons have their own children, the land was further divided and it become very hard to earn from that small piece of land.

- ✧ There are many instances of denial of equal right to vote .
- In Saudi Arabia women do not have the right to vote .
- Estonia has made its citizenship rules in such a way that people belonging to Russian minority find it difficult to get the right to vote .
- In Fiji, the electoral system is such that the vote of an indigenous Fijian has more value than that of an Indian-Fijian .



- In Balampur, there are 60 families of medium and large farmers who cultivate more than 2 hectares of land .
- A few of the large farmers have land extending over 10 hectares or more .

Graph 1.1: Distribution of Cultivated Area and Farmers



5. Who will provide the labour?

- ▶ After land, labour is the next necessary factor for production.
- ▶ Farming requires a great deal of hard work.
- ▶ Small farmers along with their families cultivate their own fields.
- ▶ Thus, they provide the labour required for farming themselves.
- ▶ Medium and large farmers hire farm labourers to work on their fields.
- ▶ Farm labourers come either from landless families or families cultivating small plots of land.
- ▶ Unlike farmers, farm labourers do not have a right over the crops grown on the land.
- ▶ Instead they are paid wages by the farmer for whom they work.
- ▶ Wages vary widely from region to region, from crop to crop, from one farm activity to another (like sowing and harvesting).
- ▶ There is also a wide variation in the duration of employment.
- ▶ A farm labourer might be employed on a daily basis, or for one particular farm activity like harvesting, or for the whole year.
- ▶ Dala is a landless farm labourer who works on daily wages in Palampur.
- ▶ This means he must regularly look for work.
- ▶ The minimum wages for a farm labourers set by the government is Rs 115 (April, 2011) per day, but Dala gets only Rs. 80.
- ▶ There is heavy competition for work among the farm labourers in Palampur, so people agree to work for lower wages.

6. The capital needed in farming

- ▶ Most small farmers have to borrow money to arrange for the capital.
- ▶ They borrow from large farmers or the village moneylenders or the traders who supply various inputs for cultivation.
- ▶ The rate of interest on such loans is very high.

- ▷ They are put to great distress to repay the loan.
- ▷ In contrast to the small farmers, the medium and large farmers have their own savings from farming.
- ▷ They are thus able to arrange for the capital needed.

Savita is a small farmer. She plans to cultivate wheat on her 1 hectare of land. Besides seeds, fertilizers and pesticides, she needs cash to buy water and repair her farm instruments. She estimates that the working capital itself would cost a minimum of Rs 3,000. She doesn't have the money, so she decides to borrow from Tejpal Singh, a large farmer. Tejpal Singh agrees to give Savita the loan at an interest rate of 24 per cent for four months, which is a very high interest rate. Savita also has to promise to work on his field as a farm labourer during the harvest season at Rs 35 per day. As you can tell, this wage is quite low. Savita knows that she will have to work very hard to complete harvesting on her own field, and then work as a farm labourer for Tejpal Singh. The harvest time is a very busy time. As a mother of three children she has a lot of household responsibilities. Savita agrees to these tough conditions as she knows getting a loan is difficult for a small farmer.



7. Sale of Surplus Farm Products

- ▷ After harvesting, farmers retain a part of the wheat for the family's consumption and sell the surplus wheat.
- ▷ Small farmers have little surplus wheat because their total production is small and from this a substantial share is kept for their own family needs.
- ▷ So it is the medium and large farmers who supply wheat to the market.

► The traders at the market buy the wheat and sell it further to shopkeepers in the towns and cities.

Tejpal Singh, the large farmer, has a surplus of 350 quintals of wheat from all his lands! He sells the surplus wheat at the Raiganj market and has good earnings.

What does Tejpal Singh do with his earnings? Last year, Tejpal Singh had put most of the money in his bank account. Later he used the savings for lending to farmers like Savita who were in need of a loan. He also used the savings to arrange for the working capital for farming in the next season. This year Tejpal Singh plans to use his earnings to buy another tractor. Another tractor would increase his fixed capital.

- Like Tejpal Singh, other large and medium farmers sell the surplus farm products.
- A part of the earnings is saved and kept for buying capital for the next season.
- Thus, they are able to arrange for the capital for farming from their own savings.
- Some farmers might also use the savings to buy cattle, trucks, or to set up shops.
- As we shall see, these constitute the capital for non-farm activities.

Non - Farm Activities in Palampur

We have learnt about farming as the main production activity in Palampur.

We shall now take a look at some of the non-farm production activities.

Only 25% of the people working in Palampur are engaged in activities other than agriculture.

Dairy - The Other Common Activity

- Dairy is a common activity in many family of Palampur.
- People feed their buffalos on various kinds of grass and the jowar and bajra that grows during the rainy season.
- The milk is sold in Raiganj, the nearby large village.
- Two traders from Shahpur town have set up collection cum chilling centres at Raiganj from where the milk is transported to far away towns and cities.

♦ An Example of Small-Scale Manufacturing in Palampur

- At present, less than fifty people are engaged in manufacturing in Palampur.
- Unlike the manufacturing that takes place in the big factories in the towns and cities, manufacturing in Palampur involves very simple production methods and are done on a small scale.
- They are carried out mostly at home or in the fields with the help of family labour.
- Rarely are labourers hired.

Mishrilal has purchased a mechanical sugarcane crushing machine run on electricity and has set it up on his field. Sugarcane crushing was earlier done with the help of bullocks, but people prefer to do it by machines these days. Mishrilal also buys sugarcane from other farmers and processes it into jaggery. The jaggery is then sold to traders at Shahpur. In the process, Mishrilal makes a small profit.



The Shopkeepers of Palampur

- People involved in trade (exchange of goods) are not many in Palampur.
- The traders of Palampur are shopkeepers who buy various goods from wholesale markets in the cities and sell them in the village.
- You will see small general stores in the village selling a wide range of items like rice, wheat, sugar, tea, oil, biscuits, soap, toothpaste, pen, pencil, batteries, candles even some cloth.
- A few of the families whose houses are close to the bus stand have used a part of the space to open small shops.
 - They sell eatables.

Kareem has opened a computer class centre in the village. In recent years a large number of students have been attending college in Shahpur town. Kareem found that a number of students from the village are also attending computer classes in the town. There were two women in the village who had a degree in computer applications. He decided to employ them. He bought computers and set up the classes in the front room of their house overlooking the market. High school students have started attending them in good numbers.



Transport : A Fast Developing Sector

- There are variety of vehicles on the road connecting Palampur to Raiganj.
 - Rickshaw-wallahs,
 - Tongawalas,
 - Jeep
 - Tractors
 - Truck drivers and people driving the traditional bullock cart and bagey are people in the transport services.

- They ferry people and goods from one place to another, and in return get paid for it.
- The number of people involved in transport has grown over the last several years.

Kishora is a farm labourer. Like other such labourers, Kishora found it difficult to meet his family's needs from the wages that he received. A few years back Kishora took a loan from the bank. This was under a government programme which was giving cheap loans to poor landless households. Kishora bought a buffalo with this money. He now sells the buffalo's milk.

Further, he has attached a wooden cart to his buffalo and uses it to transport various items. Once a week, he goes to the river Ganga to bring back clay for the potter. Or sometimes he goes to Shahpur with a load of jaggery or other commodities. Every month he gets some work in transport. As a result, Kishora is able to earn more than what he used to do some years back.

